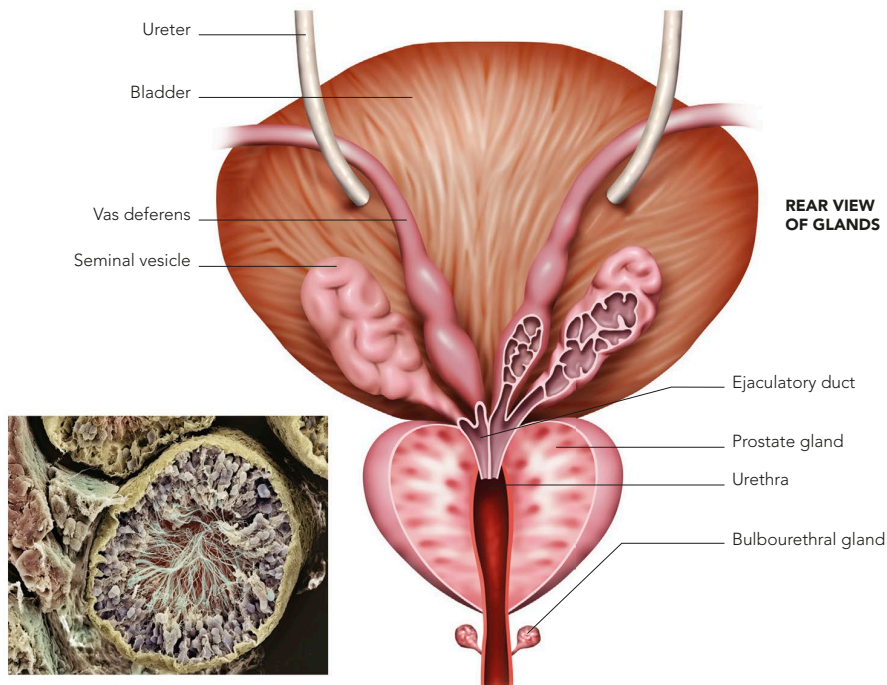


ACCESSORY GLANDS

The seminal vesicles and the prostate and bulbourethral glands are together termed the accessory glands. Their secretions are added to sperm during ejaculation. Fluids from the seminal vesicles makes up about 60 per cent of semen by volume, and contain sugar (fructose), vitamin C, and prostaglandins.

Prostate secretions account for about 30 per cent of semen, and include enzymes, fatty acids, cholesterol, and salts to adjust the semen's acid-alkali balance. Secretions from the bulbourethral glands make up 5 per cent of semen, and neutralize the acidity of urine traces in the urethra.



MAKING SPERM

Each testis is a mass of more than 800 tightly looped and folded seminiferous tubules. Here, sperm begin as blob-like cells called spermatogonia lining the inner wall. As they mature, they develop tails and move steadily towards the middle of the tubule. Thousands of sperm are produced every second, each taking about two months to mature.

